

THE OECD TAX-BENEFIT MODEL FOR ITALY

Description of policy rules for 2017



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This version : June 2018 – via <http://www.oecd.org/els/benefits-and-wages.htm>

REFERENCE: No. VS/2015/0427 (DI150030 & DI151310)

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Preface

The [OECD Tax-Benefit model \(TaxBEN\)](#) incorporates detailed policy rules for tax liabilities and benefit entitlements as they apply to individual families across OECD member countries. Its main use is to calculate the amount of taxes that people are liable to pay, and the government transfers they are likely to receive, in different family and labour-market situations. The model includes legal policy rules that are relevant for people of **working age** (from 18 years old until the statutory retirement age) and their dependent children. Income tax liabilities and benefit entitlements are calculated for a broad set of *stylised* families (“vignettes”, e.g. a married couple of 40 years old adults with two children aged 4 and 6 respectively). Model users are free to change many of these characteristics, including the age and number of children, activity status of adult members, hours of work, current and past earnings levels, unemployment duration, social contribution records, and housing-related costs. The model has been updated annually since the early 2000s for most OECD countries.

TaxBEN’s policy scope includes the main taxes on employment income (earnings), social contributions paid by individuals and by employers, as well as the main cash and near-cash benefit programmes, including unemployment benefits, family benefits, guaranteed minimum-income benefits, cash housing benefits, and employment-conditional benefits. Disability benefits and support for non-parental childcare are included for a sub-set of countries and years. The most important policy areas that are outside the scope of the model include taxes on wealth (e.g. taxes on immovable and unmovable properties, including local taxes), indirect taxes (e.g. VAT), early-retirement benefits, sickness benefits and in-kind transfers (e.g. free school meals, subsidised transport and free health care).

This report describes the taxes and benefits that are included in the model and focuses on the rules that are relevant for family, individual and labour-market circumstances that are within its scope. The **Annex** provides information on other cash benefits and taxes on employment incomes that can be relevant for some members of the working-age population, but which are not included in the TaxBEN model.

Reading notes and further details on the scope and content of this report

- The **reference date** for policy rules described in this report is **July 1, 2017**.
- **Guidelines for completing and updating this report** are provided [here](#).
- Further information on the model, model results, and references to reports and analytical uses is available on the [project website](#). A [methodology](#) document provides a full description of the assumptions underlying the model as well as the model choices that users can make. The symbol  in the text provides a link to a glossary of technical terms.
- Section titles provide the names of taxes and benefits as they are known in the country: first, direct translation into English, then (in brackets) the name in the national language.
- In order to facilitate transparency between the policy descriptions and the associated code in the model, the variable names are indicated in the text in square brackets using the following format: **[variable name]**, for instance: **[AW]** for the average wage.

The OECD tax-benefit model for Italy: Policy rules in 2017

1. Reference wages

The 2017 average wage **[AW]** is EUR 31 037.¹

There was no statutory minimum wage in Italy in 2017.

2. Unemployment benefits

In Italy the 2017 unemployment benefit system was characterised by the following schemes: i) two unemployment insurance benefits, one for private sector employees (*Nuova assicurazione per l'impiego*, NASPI) and another for dependent self-employed workers, postdoctoral research fellows and PhD students with scholarships (*DISS-COLL*); ii) a means-tested unemployment assistance benefit (*Assegno Sociale di DISoccupazione*, ASDI); iii) wage supplementation funds (*Cassa Integrazione Guadagni*, – henceforth CIG, either ordinary or special), and iv) a “mobility” allowance (*Assegno di Mobilità*).

Section 2.1 describes the NASPI and Section 2.2 the ASDI. The other schemes are outside the scope of the OECD tax-benefit model and are described in the Annex.

2.1. Unemployment benefit (*Nuova assicurazione per l'impiego* - NASPI)

Variable names:² **[UI_p; UI_s]**

This is an unemployment insurance benefit. It is contributory, not means-tested and taxable. 

2.1.1. Eligibility conditions

NASPI is intended for all workers who have involuntarily lost their jobs. The only excluded categories are permanent public employees and temporary and permanent agricultural workers.

Contribution/employment history: 13 weeks of contributions in the four years preceding the unemployment event and at least 30 days of work in the 12 months prior to the beginning of the period of unemployment.

¹ AW refers to the Average Wage provided by the [Centre for Tax Policy and Administration](#). For more information on the methodology for the AW calculation please see the annex of the latest [Taxing Wages publication](#).

² The variable names ending with “_p” refer to the first adult (so-called “principal” adult) whereas those ending with “_s” are related to the spouse.

Behavioural requirements and related eligibility conditions:  TaxBEN assumes that the benefit claimant satisfies the following compulsory conditions:³

- Registered with the public employment service (“*Centri per l’impiego*”);
- Not working;
- Involuntarily unemployed;⁴
- Actively seeking employment, ready to enter into employment relationships without delay or to take up any active labour market programme.

2.1.2. *Benefit amount*

The amount payable for the NASPI is 75% for prior monthly wages <EUR 1,195; for higher wages benefit is increased by 25% of the difference between the worker's wage and this threshold. Maximum amount is EUR 1,300. The benefit is reduced by 3% per month from the first day of the fourth month.

2.1.3. *Benefit duration*

Waiting period is typically eight days. Benefit duration is equal to half the number of weeks for which social contributions were paid in the four years before the start of unemployment. The maximum duration is 24 months in 2017. Weeks that have already given rise to the payment of unemployment benefits are excluded from the computation of the NASPI duration.

2.1.4. *Means test*

The benefit is not means-tested.

2.1.5. *Tax treatment*

NASPI benefit is subject to the income tax. The benefit is exempt from social security contribution payments although imputed contributions are attributed to the benefit recipients.

2.1.6. *Interactions with other components of the tax-benefit system*

Unemployment benefit payments are suspended for the duration of the parental leave. Payment of the unemployment benefit is suspended also for the duration of the sickness benefit but only when the sickness started within 60 days from the dismissal.

³ Details on behavioural requirements and sanction provisions for unemployment benefits are reported in regularly updated companion reports, see Immervoll and Knotz (2018, forthcoming), [Langenbucher \(2015\)](#) and [Venn \(2011\)](#).

⁴ Workers who quit their job voluntarily are not entitled to the NASPI unless: i) there is a “consensual resolution” of the employment contract; ii) the resignation are made during the protected maternity period, i.e. from 300 days before the presumed date of childbirth until the child's first year of life, or for “just-cause”

2.1.7. Combining benefit receipt and employment/starting a new job

NASpI payments are suspended if the jobseeker takes up a temporary employment of no more than 6 months and the expected annual taxable earnings from this job are above EUR 8,000. If taxable earnings are below EUR 8,000 a *reduced* benefit amount is still payable *independently of the contract duration*. The reduced benefit amount is equal to the original benefit amount minus 80% of the taxable earnings that are earned between the beginning of the new job and the end of the fiscal year (or the end of the NASpI if the benefit ends before the end of the new job).

2.2. Unemployment Assistance (Assegno Sociale di Disoccupazione, ASDI)

Variable names:⁵ [UA_p; UA_s]

This is a means-tested unemployment assistance benefit; it is not contributory and not taxable. 

2.2.1. Eligibility conditions

ASDI is provided to jobseekers who have finished the NASpI and meet the following entitlement criteria:

- The jobseeker lives with at least one minor and/or is at least 55 years old, without having completed the requirements for retirement;
- ISEE indicator does not exceed EUR 5000 (see BOX 1 for details on the ISEE indicator);
- did not received ASDI for periods longer than 6 months in the 12 months prior to the end of NASpI and, in any case for a period of at least 24 months in the previous 5 years;
- Have signed an individual project at the employment service.

2.2.2. Benefit amount

The amount of ASDI is 75 percent of last NASpI if not higher than social allowance (EUR 448.50). This amount may be increased based on the number of dependent children as below.

Number of children	Increase (EUR) per month
1	89.70
2	116.60
3	140.80
4	163.82

2.2.3. Benefit duration

ASDI is paid from the first day of the end of the NASpI and for a maximum duration of six months.

⁵ The variable names ending with “_p” refer to the first adult (so-called “principal” adult) whereas those ending with “_s” are related to the spouse.

2.2.4. Means test

Only jobseekers who have an ISEE indicator that does not exceed EUR 5000 are entitled to the ASDI (see Annex 2 for details on the ISEE indicator);

2.2.5. Tax treatment

ASDI is not subject to the income tax or social security contributions.

2.2.6. Interactions with other components of the tax-benefit system

Same as for the NASpI (see above)

2.2.7. Combining benefit receipt and employment/starting a new job

Same as for the NASpI (see above)

Box 1. The ISEE Indicator

The Equivalent Economic Situation Indicator (Indicatore della Situazione economica Equivalente - ISEE) is calculated as follows:

$$\text{ISEE} = (\text{ISR} + 20\% \text{ ISP})/\text{EQ}$$

Where ISR is the Income Situation Index (ISR), ISP is the Asset Situation Index and EQ is the equivalence scale. The Income Situation Index (ISR) is equal to the sum of the household gross incomes (nearly any source, including incomes from financial assets and non-taxable incomes – incomes from employment include unemployment insurance benefits and are net of the employee social security contributions), minus a series of ‘credits’:

ISR = gross household incomes – credits

The main credits are: a) Alimonies paid to a separate or divorced spouse; b) Health expenses for disabled relatives (up to EUR 5000); c) 20% of incomes from employment or similar/related sources, up to a EUR 3000; d) Alternative to (c), 20% of the income from non-taxable benefits or pensions, up to a EUR 1000; e) Annual rent for family living in rental accommodations, up to EUR 7000 (this amount is increased of 500 EUR for each child after the second); f) EUR 4000 EUR for each person with “average” disability (EUR 5500 EUR in case of disabled children); EUR 5500 EUR for each person with “severe” disability (EUR 7500 EUR in case of disabled children); EUR 7000 EUR for fully incapacitated persons (EUR 9500 EUR in case of disabled children). These allowances can be deducted up to the maximum limit of the value of the ISR (the ISR cannot be negative).

The Asset Situation Index (ISP) is the sum of the household wealth, which includes both movable and immovable properties, net of the respective deductions and allowances:

ISP= (total wealth – credits).

As wealth is assumed to be zero in the OECD tax-benefit model, the ISP is not described.

The indicator is equal to zero if the sum of ISR + 20% ISP is negative.

The Equivalence Scale (EQ) is equal to the number of household members at the power

of 0.65 for households with less than 6 members. For household with 6+ members the parameter is increased by 0.35 for each additional member. The following increases applies to the EQ rates:

a) 0.2 increase for households with 3 children, 0.35 for 4 children, 0.5 for at least 5 children; b) 0.2 for households with children below 18 years (0.3 if there is at least one child aged less than three) in which both parents or the only parent have worked for at least six months during the year; c) the increase described in letter b) applies also to households composed exclusively of one non-working parent with children below 18 years.

3. Social assistance and housing benefits

3.1. Social Assistance (*Sostegno per l’Inclusione Attiva, SIA*)

Variable name: **[SA]**

A national anti-poverty allowance known as “*Sostegno per l’Inclusione Attiva*” (SIA) has been accessible since September 2nd 2016. SIA is an economic benefit in the form of a prepaid card.

3.1.1. Eligibility conditions

- At least one workless person in the household
- ISEE indicator below EUR 3,000 (see Box 1 for the ISEE indicator);
- Not being a SIA recipient in the last 6 months;
- At least one household member in one of the following conditions: under 18 years of age, disable, pregnant;
- Receipt of other income-support measures (national or local) for no more than EUR 600 per year (EUR 900 for families with disabled individuals). No income support from unemployment benefits (either NASPI or ASDI).
- Score of at least 45 out of 90 points with the SIA indicator of “multidimensional needs”. This indicator takes into account: 1) Economic resources (maximum 25 points) based on the rule: $25 - (ISEE/120)$; 2) Number of workers: +10 points for workless households, otherwise zero; 3) care responsibilities (maximum 65 points): +10, +20, +25 points for 2, 3, 4+ children below 18; +5 points is there is a child of less than three years; +25 points in case of lone parents; +5 points is there is a family member with severe but not full disability, +10 points is there is at least a family member who is fully incapable and not self-sufficient.

Other compulsory eligibility conditions are assumed to be always satisfied when simulating this benefit in TaxBEN, in particular: participation in the activation measures included in the personalised “activation plan” that the household has to sign off for claiming the benefit; availability to work for capable adult household members who are not in full-time education; no family members who have registered a vehicle in the 12 months preceding the claim or who own a vehicle with an engine capacity exceeding 1,300 cc or motorcycles above 250 cc; Italian / EU citizenship, otherwise residency in the country for at least two years.

3.1.2. Benefit amount

The benefit depends on the number of family members as follows:

<i>Number of family members</i>	<i>Benefit amount (EUR) per month</i>
1	80
2	160
3	240
4	320
5+	400

3.1.3. Benefit duration

12 months. The benefit can be renewed after a period of 6 months.

3.1.4. Means test

ISEE indicator below EUR 3,000 (see Box 1 for the ISEE indicator);

3.1.5. Tax treatment

The benefit is not taxable.

3.1.6. Interaction with other components of the tax-benefit system

SIA is not compatible with the receipt of unemployment benefits (either NASPI or ASDI). The increase (*only*) in the amount of the “*bonus beb *” received by low-income families (Section 4.1), as well as the *full* amount of the allowance for large families (Section 4.2) are deducted from the SIA amount as applicable.

3.1.7. Combining benefit receipt and employment/starting a new job

This benefit is compatible with work activities so long as at least one adult family member is out of work.

3.2. Housing benefit (*Contributo per l'affitto*)

Variable name: **[HB]**

In Italy housing policies are for owners of the main residence - usually in the form of tax credits related to mortgage loan interests, rebates on property transfer taxes; low interest loans which are means-tested and regulated by local legislation, all in the case of first-time buyers - as well as for those who live in rental accommodations. Considering the TaxBEN scope, only housing policies for rental accommodations are considered in this report.

Housing assistance for rental accommodations can take different forms: tax credits; ii) rent subsidies for low-income households; iii) restrictions to rent increases; iv) controlled rents for State-owned dwellings. Only tax credits and rent subsidies for low-income households are within the scope of the OECD tax-benefit model. Restrictions to rent increases and controlled rents for State-owned dwellings are described in the annex.

Rent subsidies are conditional on the availability of funds. The central government allocates every year resources to the National Fund for Rental Support (*Fondo nazionale di sostegno alle locazioni*). These resources are then distributed across regions, which can

also contribute with their own funds. Regions define the eligibility conditions, benefit amounts and duration. The fund is then distributed among municipalities in each region that manage its delivery. As in **2017 the government did not allocate resources to this fund** rent subsidies are not modelled for 2017.

As a result, the main national housing policy for families living in rental accommodations remains a means-tested tax relief that is described in **Section 7**.

4. Family benefits

4.1. Family allowance (*Assegni al Nucleo Familiare*)

Variable name: `[FB_main]`

This is a contributory benefit, means-tested and not taxable.

4.1.1. Eligibility conditions

The family allowance scheme grants cash transfers to employees, unemployment benefit recipients, project workers, and former-employee pensioners. It does not cover self-employed. The household definition includes the benefit claimant, his/her spouse, children if aged less than 18 or 21 when they are students (or 26 if living in households with at least 4 children), dependent grandchildren, brothers or sisters. Note that households without children are also eligible.

Eligibility to the benefit requires the household income to be made for at least 70 per cent by income from employment. As unemployment benefits in Italy are considered earnings from employment they are part of the 70% share. Household income should include all incomes that are subject to the income tax minus the employee social security contributions, as well as incomes that are exempted from the income tax (with the exception of some benefits for persons with severe disabilities).

4.1.2. Benefit amount

Family allowances vary with: 1) household type; 2) the number of family members and 3) the household taxable income. Benefit amounts and household income bands are adjusted yearly to the consumer price index. The excel workbook [here](#) (in Italian) provides the amounts that are applied between July 1 and December 31. Worksheets are organized by family type as follows (only potentially-relevant worksheets are listed using the original Italian names translated in English):

- “Tab. 11”: Married couples with at least one minor and without household members with disabilities
- “Tab. 12”: Lone parents with at least one minor and without household members with disabilities
- “Tab. 14”: 2-adult families with at least one minor and one household member with disabilities.
- “Tab. 15”: 1-adult families with at least one minor and one household member with disabilities.
- “Tab. 21A”: Married couples without children and without disabilities
- “Tab. 21C”: Married couples without children and with at least one disable partner

In each worksheet benefit amounts vary by number of family members (columns) and by family taxable income (by rows).

Workers receive the entire amount of the benefit if they work throughout the year.. For instance, if the recipient works only one day out of six, then the benefit is 1/6 of the full amount. No reduction applies if the recipient works less than full time throughout the year, as the reduction depends on the number of days worked rather than the number of hours.

4.1.3. Benefit duration

As long as the eligibility conditions hold.

4.1.4. Means test

The benefit is a step-wise decreasing function of household income (see section 4.1.2).

4.1.5. Tax treatment

The benefit is not taxable.

4.1.6. Interaction with other components of the tax-benefit system

The benefit can be received together with other benefits as long as the family meets the eligibility criteria and passes the means test.

4.1.7. Combining benefit receipt and employment/starting a new job

Employment is a pre-requisite for benefit eligibility. Unemployed benefit recipients can also claim the benefits as they have the status of “former employees”. Starting of a new job does not affect eligibility but can have effects on entitlements.

4.1.8. Treatment of particular groups

Both the income brackets and the amounts of allowances to dependent workers are modified whenever disabled people and/or lone parents are present within the family (see section 4.1.2)

4.1.9. Combining benefit receipt and employment/starting a new job

Employment doesn’t affect benefit receipt.

4.2. Allowance for large families (*Assegno per famiglie numerose*)

This benefit is paid by the municipalities but then reimbursed by the National Social Security Institute. It therefore qualifies as a national measure.

Variable name: **[A3F]**

This is a non-contributory benefit, means-tested and not taxable.

4.2.1. Eligibility conditions

Eligible households must have at least three children younger than 18.

4.2.2. *Benefit amount*

The benefit amount in 2017 was EUR 141.30 per month. Families with more than 4 children are eligible for a second allowance of EUR 500 per months.

4.2.3. *Benefit duration*

13 months, renewable. The total amount is paid in two lumps at the end of the first semester and after the end of the second semester.

4.2.4. *Means test*

ISEE indicator below EUR 8 555.99 for families with 3 children. For family with 4 more than 4 children the ISEE threshold is lower at EUR 8 500.

4.2.5. *Tax treatment*

Non-taxable.

4.2.6. *Interaction with other components of the tax-benefit system*

The benefit cannot be combined with other maternity benefits.

4.2.7. *Combining benefit receipt and employment/starting a new job*

Employment does not affect benefit receipt.

4.3. **Natality allowance** (*Bonus bébé*)

Variable name: [\[bonus_bb\]](#)

This is a non-contributory benefit, means-tested and not taxable.

4.3.1. *Eligibility conditions*

This benefit is paid to those families where there is a child born between 1 January 2015 and 31 December 2018. The bonus is paid only once independently of the number of children who are born during this period.

4.3.2. *Benefit amount*

The amount is EUR 80 per month for households with an ISEE below 25 000. The amount is EUR 160 if the ISEE is below EUR 7 000.

4.3.3. *Benefit duration*

The benefit is paid monthly until the child turns three. TaxBEN assume that the child was born on January 1, so that every year the family receives the maximum amount.

4.3.4. *Means test*

ISEE indicator below EUR 25 000.

4.3.5. *Tax treatment*

Non-taxable.

4.3.6. Interaction with other components of the tax-benefit system

The benefit can be received together with any other benefit, but is counted as income in the means tests for other benefits as relevant.

4.3.7. Combining benefit receipt and employment/starting a new job

Employment doesn't affect benefit receipt.

5. Childcare for pre-school children

Important note: The **reference date** for the rules described in this section is **July 1, 2015**.⁶

Childcare provisions for children 0-3 years old are administered at the municipal level. They have a high degree of variability at national level, as well as at regional level and even for the same province or municipality. Below is reported the case of the **municipality of Rome**.⁷

5.1. Gross childcare fees

Variable name: `[ITcc_cost]`

In Rome the maximum age for admission in the public playschool is 2 years and six months. Gross childcare fees are set every year by the municipality and depend on two variables: the household income and the hours of childcare. The table below shows the monthly fee for full-time childcare (from 8:00 am to 5:00 pm) as a function of the ISEE indicator (see Box 1).

Table: gross childcare fees in Rome

ISEE		Gross fee (month)	ISEE		Gross fee (month)
From	to		From	to	
0	5165	44			
5166	5682	49	23242	23758	237
5683	6198	54	23759	24274	242
6199	6714	59	24275	24790	247
6715	7231	64	24791	25307	252
7232	7747	68	25308	25823	257
7748	8263	73	25824	26340	263
8264	8780	78	26341	26856	268
8781	9297	83	26857	27373	273
9298	9813	88	27374	27889	279
9814	10330	93	27890	28406	284
10331	10846	105	28407	28922	289
10847	11363	110	28923	29439	294
11364	11879	116	29440	29955	299
11880	12395	121	29956	30471	305
12396	12912	126	30472	30988	333
12913	13428	132	30989	31504	338
13429	13945	137	31505	32021	344

⁶ The childcare module of the tax-benefit model is updated every three year (next update: 2018).

⁷ The information is taken from the following page:

https://www.comune.roma.it/PCR/resources/cms/documents/tavola_riepilogativa_tariffe_nido_2016_2017.pdf

13946	14461	142	32022	32537	350
14462	14978	147	32538	33054	355
14979	15494	152	33055	33570	361
15495	16011	158	33571	34087	367
16012	16527	163	34088	34603	372
16528	17044	168	34604	35120	378
17045	17560	174	35121	35636	383
17561	18076	179	35637	36152	389
18077	18593	184	36153	36669	395
18594	19109	189	36670	37185	400
19110	19626	195	37186	37702	406
19627	20142	200	37703	38218	412
20143	20659	205	38219	38735	417
20660	21175	210	38736	39251	423
21176	21692	216	39252	39768	429
21693	22208	221	39769	40284	434
22209	22725	226	40285	40801	440
22726	23241	231	40802	end	446

5.1.1. Discounts for part-time usage (not modelled)

Fees vary depending on the hours of childcare and the time of the day. The table below shows the coefficients to convert the fee in the table above to the other available cases. To calculate the fee families have to multiply the coefficient by the values in the table above.

Daily hours	From 7:00 to 18:00	From 7:30 to 18:00	From 8:00 to 18:00	From 7:30 to 16:30	From 7:00 To 14:30	From 7:30 to 14:30	From 8:00 to 14:30	From 9:00 to 14:30
Hours of childcare	(11h)	(10h30)	(10h)	(8h)	(7h:30)	(7h)	(6h:30)	(5h:30)
Coefficient	1.243	1.186	1.130	0.868	0.810	0.756	0.639	1.243

5.2. Fee discounts and free provision

Variable name: `[cc_subsidy]`

The municipality of Rome applies the following discounts:

- 30% rebate of the total fees if the family has 2 children who both attending the playschool.
- 30% rebate of the total fees if the ISEE is between EUR 20 000 and 40 000, and the family has 3 or more children with at least one under 2 who is attending the playschool whereas the other are in school age (i.e. above 2).
- Full exemption if the ISEE is below EUR 20 000, and the family has 3 or more children with at least one below two who is attending the playschool whereas the other are in school age (i.e. above 2).

5.3. Child-care benefits for formal centre-based care (Bonus nido)

Variable name: `[cc_benefit]`

In the municipality of Rome there are no special childcare benefits. However, in 2017 a national measure called “*Bonus nido*” is available for parents of young children using non-parental childcare.

5.3.1. Eligibility

Bonus nido is available for parents with children under three years born or adopted from 1 January 2016 onwards. Children must be registered in a public or private playschool.

5.3.2. Benefit amount

EUR 1 000 per year, paid in 11 instalments of EUR 90.91 each. The instalments cannot exceed the costs paid to the playschool, which should be declared in the INPS application form.

5.3.1. Benefit duration

Three years

5.3.2. Means test

There is no means test

5.3.3. Tax treatment

Non-taxable

5.3.4. Interaction with other benefits

The benefit cannot be cumulated with the tax rebate for childcare expenses described in Section 7. The benefit can be cumulated with other maternity-related benefits such as the “bonus bebé”. It can be also cumulated with the “*Voucher asilo nido and baby-sitting*” (see Annex) so long as the two benefits are used to cover childcare costs of different months.

5.4. Child care allowance for children not using child care centers

None.

5.5. Tax concessions for childcare expenditures

Families can benefit from a particular tax concession for expenditures in child care centres, see section 7 for details.

6. Social security contributions and payroll taxes

6.1. Employee social security contributions (*Contributi Sociali a carico del lavoratore*)

Variable names: `[SOCSEC_p; SOCSEC_s; SSCR_p; SSCR_s]`

6.1.1. Rates and ceilings

- The average rate is 9.49 per cent on earnings up to EUR 46 123.
- The average rate is 10.49 per cent on earnings over EUR 46 123 and up to EUR 100 324.
- For earnings exceeding EUR 100 324, the employee pays a fixed amount given by:

$$(0.0949 \times 46\,123) + 0.1049 \times (100\,324 - 46\,123).$$

6.1.2. *Treatment of particular groups, e.g. youth, women, disabled, older workers*

- None.

6.2. *Employer social security contributions (Contributi Sociali a carico del datore di lavoro)*

6.2.1. *Rates and ceilings*

Contributions equal 31.58% on earnings up to EUR 100 324. For earnings exceeding EUR 100 324, the employer pays a fixed amount given by $0.3158 \times 100\,324$.

In 2015 Italy introduced a 3-year 100% social security contribution exemption up to EUR 8,060 per year for employers hiring with open-ended contracts. In 2016, this exemption was limited to 40% of the employer social security contributions, the maximum exemption was up to EUR 3,250 and granted for two years. The exemption was not renewed in 2017, instead Italy approved a series of other exemptions for targeted groups:⁸

- “*Bonus for women*”: 50% rebate for a period of 18 months when upon hiring women who have been out of work for more than 24 months (six months if the firm operates in disadvantaged areas). The full subsidy can be claimed for new open-ended contracts or for conversions of short-term contracts into open-ended ones. Hiring with short-term contracts is also subsidised, but only for 12 months.
- “*Bonus for workers 50+*”: 50% rebate for a period of 18 months when upon hiring a person of 50+ years old who has been out of work for more than 12 months. The full subsidy can be claimed for new open-ended contracts or for conversions of short-term contracts into open-ended ones. Hiring with short-term contracts is also subsidised, but only for 12 months.
- “*Bonus for young parents*”: Another measure focuses on younger parents (up to 35 years) with dependent children and takes the form of a hiring bonus of EUR 5,000 for each new employee.
- “*Bonus for youth living in the southern regions*”: an employment subsidy granted for hiring young (16-24) NEETs in the southern regions (Basilicata, Calabria, Campania, Puglia, Sicilia, Abruzzo, Molise and Sardinia). The bonus consists of a contribution of up to EUR 8,060/year for each new open-ended (or apprenticeship) contract. Fixed-term contracts are also subsidised but the incentive is reduced of 50%. This bonus is not simulated in the TaxBEN model as it is not a national measure.
- “*Bonus for unemployment benefit recipients*”: 20% of NASPI benefit entitlement (see section 1), received for the remaining benefit duration.
- “*Bonus for individuals with disabilities*”: a rebate equal to a given fraction of the monthly gross earnings. The rebate and its duration depend on the level and type of disability (not simulated in the TaxBEN model).

⁸ These new targeted programmes for 2017, as well as the 2015-2016 tax exemption, are not simulated in the OECD Tax-Benefit model.

- “Youth Guarantee bonus”: private sector employers hiring young NEET participating in the Youth Guarantee programme and aged between 15 and 29 are entitled to a reduction of up to EUR 8,060/year for each new open-ended (or apprenticeship) contract. Fixed-term contracts are also subsidised but the incentive is reduced of 50%. The actual amount depends on the profiling class of the NEET, which depends on their employability profile.

7. Taxes

Employment income is subject to an individual progressive income tax. The taxation period is the calendar year.

7.1. Personal income tax (*Imposta sui Redditi delle Persone Fisiche, IRPEF*)

Variable name: `[IT_p; IT_s]`

7.1.1. Tax base

Tax base is calculated as the sum of the following incomes: Employment income, business income, self-employment income, real estate income, investment income, capital gains. Income from unemployment insurance is considered employment income and is therefore part of the tax base. Family benefits, housing benefits and other non-contributory benefits are exempted from the income tax.

7.1.2. Tax allowances

The main deductions from the gross income are: 1) employee’s social security contributions; 2) Voluntary contributions paid to complementary pension funds up to EUR 5 164.57; 3) Voluntary contributions paid to mandatory pension schemes; 4) social security contributions paid for domestic workers (up to EUR 1 549.37); 5) Medical expenses for disabled individuals; 6) alimony paid to a separate or divorced spouse; 7) Contributions to certain religious entities (up to EUR 1 032.91)

7.1.3. Income tax schedule

The following tax schedule is applied to taxable income:

Bracket (EUR)		Rate (%)
up to	15 000	23
over	15 000 up to 28 000	27
over	28 000 up to 55 000	38
over	55 000 up to 75 000	41
over	75 000	43

Between 2011 and 2016 (included) there was “solidarity contribution” (*Contributo di Solidarietà*) of 3% on the portion of income higher than EUR 300 000 (the amount paid is deductible from PIT base)”. From 2017 onwards the “*Contributo di solidarietà*” measure is not in force.

7.1.4. Tax credits

Tax payers in Italy can deduct from gross tax liability three main types of tax credits: 1) Income-related tax credits; 2) family tax credits; 3) Other tax credits.

1. Income-related tax credits

Taxable income (EUR)	Income-related tax credit (EUR)
Up to 8000	1880
From 8001 to 28000	$978 + 902 \cdot (28000 - \text{taxable income}) / 20000$
From 28001 to 55000	$978 \cdot (55000 - \text{taxable income}) / 27000$
More than 55000	0

The income-related tax credits do not depend on whether the employee works full time or part time. However, for those employees who have worked only part of the year the tax credit is reduced by multiplying the amount above (TC) by NW/365, where NW is the number of actual working days during the fiscal year: Final tax credit = TC * NW / 365. The tax credit cannot be lower than EUR 690 (EUR 1380 for temporary contracts).

Incomes from other sources, notably from self-employment and old-age pensions, are subject to different income-related tax credits.

2. Family tax credits

Family tax credits are granted to taxpayers with a dependant spouse, children, and other relatives living with the taxpayer, provided that each dependant's annual taxable income does not exceed EUR 2,840.51.

Family tax credits are rated monthly and are applied as of the month in which the conditions verify and up to the month in which conditions stop. The family tax credit varies according to the type of dependant:

Family tax credits (EUR)*	Amount (EUR)
<u>Dependent children</u>	
Under three years of age	$1220 \cdot (95\,000 - \text{taxable income}) / 95\,000$
Over three years of age	$950 \cdot (95\,000 - \text{taxable income}) / 95\,000$
<u>Other dependent relatives</u>	$750 \cdot (80\,000 - \text{taxable income}) / 80\,000$
<u>Dependent spouse</u>	
Up to 15 000	$800 - 110 \cdot \text{taxable income} / 15\,000$
From 15 001 to 29 000	690
From 29 001 to 29 200	700
From 29 201 to 34 700	710
From 34 701 to 35 000	720
From 35 001 to 35 100	710
From 35 101 to 35 200	700
From 35 201 to 40 000	690
From 40 001 to 80 000	$690 \cdot (80\,000 - \text{taxable income}) / 40\,000$
More than 80 000	0

The child tax credit takes into account also the number of children:

- For families with more than one child the amount of 95 000 in the child tax credit is increased by 15 000 for each child beyond the first (so it is 95 000 for one child, 110 000 for 2 children, etc.)
- For families with more than 3 children the 'basic' tax credit amounts (i.e. EUR 950 and 1220) are increased by EUR 200 for each child from the first one. For instance, for two children under the age of 3 the basic amount becomes $(950+200) \cdot 2$, and if one of the two is under three years of age, the total amount becomes $(950+200) +$

(1220+200). For each disable child the basic tax credit for children is increased by EUR 400.

For two-earner couples, the tax credits for dependent children have to be equally shared between the parents. However, if the spouse's tax liability after the income-related tax credit is less than his/her share (i.e. 50 per cent) of the child tax credit, the entire child tax credit is allocated to the other partner.

A lone parent receives a tax credit which is equal to the maximum of the spouse tax credit and the child tax credit.

3. Other tax credits

Selected expenses entitle the taxpayer to a number of other tax credits whose rate is generally 19% of the total expense. These expenses include: mortgage interest, medical expenses, education-related expenses; university-related expenses rent-related expenses, childcare costs, life and accident insurance and sporting association's fees. Below are described the tax credits that are relevant for the TaxBEN modelling purposes.

- Tax credit for rented accommodations:** The Italian tax system provides also a tax relief to households in rental accommodations. The amount depends on the household's gross taxable income. Two income thresholds are used: EUR 15 493.71 (y1) and EUR 30 987.41 (y2). The tax credit is equal to EUR 300 if income is lower than y1 and EUR 150 if income is between y1 and y2; no credit is provided if income is greater than y2.⁹ This tax credit is refundable so long as the claimant's income tax net of income and family -related tax credits is positive, otherwise the refundable tax credit is zero. Only the family member who has signed the rent contract can claim the tax credit. For two-earner couples, TaxBEN assumes that this person is always the adult with the lowest positive taxable income, so as to maximise the amount of the tax credit (given that the credit is higher for lower earnings). As the refunded credit is paid out at the end of the fiscal year, TaxBEN classifies this credit as a housing benefit.
- Tax credit for families with at least four children:** From 2007, an additional tax credit of EUR 1200 is granted to families with at least four children. This tax credit is refundable so long as the income tax net of income-related tax credits, family-related tax credits and the tax credit for rented accommodations is still positive. For 2-earner couples, the credit is split in equal amounts between the two partners. If case of 'dependent spouse', i.e. the taxable income of the spouse is below EUR 2 840,51 per year, the credit is assigned entirely to the other partner. As the refunded credit is paid out at the end of the fiscal year, TaxBEN classifies this credit as a family benefit.

⁹ A higher tax credit is granted to: (a) households with social-rent contracts (*contratti convenzionati*); (b) people aged between 20 and 30, but only for the first three years of residence; (c) employees who move to a different place because of work, again only for the first three years of residence. In these three cases, if the household gross taxable income is lower than y1, then the tax credit is equal to EUR 495.80 for case (a) and EUR 991.60 for cases (b) and (c). If the household gross taxable income is between y1 and y2 the tax credit is equal to EUR 247.90 for case (1) and EUR 495.84 for cases (b) and (c). A tax credit of 19% of the rent is also granted to university students who study away from their hometown as long as the rent is no higher than EUR 2,633. The TaxBEN model does not simulate cases a), b) and c) as well as the tax credit for university students

- **Tax credit for child care-related expense:** the tax credit is 19% of the child-care related expenses. The maximum expense that can be declared for this tax concession is EUR 632 per child. This means that a household can receive a tax rebate of maximum EUR 120.08 per child. This tax credit is non-refundable. TaxBEN classifies this credit as a childcare benefit.

7.1.5. Regional surcharge tax

This surcharge tax is levied by each region on resident taxpayers' total taxable income at a discretionary rate, which must fall within an established range. The Tax and Benefits Model includes the regional surcharge tax paid in **Lazio**; in 2017 a progressive tax schedule is applied to taxable income:

Bracket (EUR)	Rate (%)
up to 15 000	1,73
over 15 000 up to 28 000	2,73
over 28 000 up to 55 000	2,93
over 55 000 up to 75 000	3,23
over 75 000	3,33

However, if the taxable income is below the threshold of EUR 35 000 the rate applicable to the total amount of taxable income is 1.73%.

7.1.6. Local surcharge tax

This surcharge is levied by each municipality at a standard rate of 0.2 per cent. Municipalities can increase the rate up to 0.8 (0.9 in the Capital - **Rome**). The Tax and Benefits Model includes the local surcharge tax paid in Rome; the rate is 0.9 per cent in 2017.

7.1.7. Fiscal bonus

From 2014, there is bonus of EUR 640 for employees with income between EUR 8 146 and EUR 24 000, with a phase-out for income between EUR 24 000 and EUR 26 000. This bonus is increased to EUR 960 on a permanent basis as of 2015. Only tax-payers with a positive income tax liability net of the income-related tax credit can receive this fiscal bonus.

Taxable income (EUR)	Fiscal Bonus (EUR)
Up to 8 145	0
From 8 146 to 24 000	960
From 24 001 to 26 000	$960 \cdot (26\,000 - \text{taxable income}) / 2\,000$
More than 26 000	0

In line with the income-related tax credits, the fiscal bonus do not depend on whether the employee works full time or part time. However, for those who have worked only part of the year the fiscal bonus is adjusted by multiplying the amount above ('FB') by NW/365, where NW is the number of actual working days during the fiscal year: Final bonus=FB*NW/365

Annex: Other benefits and direct taxes

This section provides a brief description of other cash benefits and taxes on employment incomes in Italy that are relevant for some members of the population below the statutory retirement age, but which are not included in the OECD tax-benefit model.

Wage supplementation funds (Cassa Integrazione Guadagni, CIG)

CIG (both Ordinary and Special) is 80 per cent of the average gross earnings paid for non-worked hours, with a maximum level of the benefit equal to that of standard unemployment benefits. CIGo (ordinary CIG) is usually paid for 13 weeks but it is possible to obtain some prorogation if the firm remains in a reduction of activity for a longer period. In any case, CIGo cannot be paid for more than 12 months, whether consecutive or non-consecutive, over a period of two years. CIGs (special CIG) is normally paid for 12 up to 24 months (the length depending on the type of difficulties that the firm faces as well as on the restructuring strategy). It is possible to obtain a prorogation if restructuring lasts more than 24 months. In any case, CIGs cannot be paid for more than 24 months over 5 years.

Workers receiving mobility benefits and CIGs are eligible for Socially Useful Jobs (*Lavori Socialmente Utili, LSU*), usually lasting 12 months (albeit prorogation for other 12 months is possible). Workers receiving mobility benefits have to compulsorily accept these jobs if they are asked to, otherwise they will lose their benefit. After 2002 LSU programs are under progressive dismantling.

If employed in LSU, workers receiving CIGs and mobility benefits maintain their benefit until it elapses. Afterwards, if they are still employed in LSU, they will receive a benefit of EUR 578,98 per month, which is the amount paid for LSU if the workers involved are not receiving any other benefit. For the year 2017 the amount is EUR 580,14 per month. Workers on mobility and CIGs are not the only ones eligible for LSU. Unemployed workers with an unemployment spell of at least two years which usually do not receive any income support are also eligible.

Mobility allowance (Assegno di mobilità)

The mobility allowance is provided in case of collective dismissals by firms eligible for benefit from the CIGs and in case of individual dismissal of workers already in CIGs or under bankruptcy proceedings.¹⁰ The bankruptcy proceeding will be no more an eligibility conditions starting from January 1, 2016. Laid-off workers, in case of collective dismissals, as of December 31, 2016 will no longer be placed in ordinary

10. Generally, mobility benefits are limited to collective dismissals (firms that have dismissed at least 5 workers in 120 days) in the manufacturing sector excluding firms with less than 15 workers.

mobility. Mobility benefits equal CIGs for the first 12 months. They are reduced by 20 per cent after one year, with a maximum level of benefit equal to that of unemployment benefits. The duration of mobility benefits depends on the age of the recipient and on the location of the job. For instance, workers under 40 are entitled to this benefit for 12 or 24 months, respectively, according to whether they had been working in the Centre-North or the South of Italy. Conversely, the benefit duration is extended up to 36 or 48 months respectively for workers over 50 (see Table 2 below). In order to receive the mobility allowance, workers must present a specific application. The request is equivalent to a declaration of immediate availability and is transmitted by the INPS to the ANPAL, so that the workers are inserted in the active policies system.

Duration of mobility benefits by age and geographical location, years 2013-2017

	Type of benefits	Centre-North < 40	Centre-North 40-49	Centre-North >50	South < 39	South 40-49	South >50
From 1/1/2013 to 31/12/2014	Mobility	12	24	36	24	36	48
From 1/1/2015 to 31/12/2015	Mobility	12	18	24	12	24	36
From 1/1/2016 to 31/12/2016	Mobility	12	12	18	12	18	24
From 1/1/2017	NASPI						

Baby sitter or nursery voucher (voucher baby sitter o asili nido)

Within the 11 months following the return after compulsory maternity leave, alternatively and in renunciation of the parental leave, mothers can use the baby sitter or nursery voucher to pay the costs of a baby sitter or a nursery school. The amount is maximum EUR 600 per month for six months in case of employees (three months in case of self-employed or entrepreneurs mothers). The contribution is paid directly to the school chosen by the mother. This measure was introduced experimentally for the years 2013-2015. The Budget Laws for 2016 and 2017 refinanced the vouchers until 2018 (included).

Maternity allowances (Assegno di maternità)

There are two types of maternity allowances: the so-called “State maternity allowance” (*Assegno di maternità dello Stato*) and the “Municipality maternity allowance” (*Assegno di maternità del comune*), which is paid by the municipalities but then reimbursed by the National Social Security Institute (*Istituto Nazionale per la Previdenza Sociale*, INPS). The main difference between the two allowances is about the eligibility conditions whereas benefit amounts and durations are the same. The two benefits cannot be cumulated. The State maternity allowance is a contributory benefit, means-tested and not taxable. The Municipality maternity allowance is a non-contributory benefit, means-tested and not taxable. Eligibility conditions: The *State* maternity allowance can be claimed by pregnant *employed* women who have paid at least 3 months of maternity contributions in the period from 18 to 9 months before childbirth. The benefit can be claimed also by women who meet the contribution requirements above but have lost their job while they were pregnant. For project (“atypical”) workers the 3 months of maternity contributions must be paid 12 months before the beginning of the compulsory ordinary maternity leave period. The *Municipality* maternity allowance is targeted to pregnant *unemployed* or economically inactive mothers who do not meet the edibility requirements

for the State maternity allowance. Both benefits are paid after the childbirth during the first year of the new born. The amount in 2017 was EUR 338.89 per month, paid for five months. Means test: for both the allowances the ISEE indicator must be below EUR 16 954.95. Both benefits can be combined with other maternity benefits including the “bonus bebé”. However, recipients of parental leave benefits cannot receive any maternity allowances.

Bonus at birth (Premio alla nascita / bonus “mamma domani”)

This benefit is paid by the National Social Security Institute (INPS). This is a non-contributory benefit, not means-tested and not taxable. This benefit is aimed at mothers who meet any one of the following requirements from 1 January 2017: seventh month of pregnancy; childbirth, even before the beginning of the eighth month of pregnancy, national or international adoption of the child; national pre-adoptive assignment of a child. The benefit amount is EUR 800, paid in a single solution at childbirth. The benefit can be received together with other benefits, but is counted as income in the means tests for other benefits as relevant. Employment doesn’t affect benefit receipt.